Chowder makes a hearty lunchtime soup for any time of year. When possible, try to purchase your wild salmon from a sustainable source.

wild salmon chowder

SERVES 4 **PREP** 15 MINS **COOK** 25 MINS PLUS 5–10 MINS RESTING **FREEZE** NOT SUITABLE

2 tbsp olive oil
4 slices bacon, chopped
6 scallions, cut into 1in (2.5cm) slices
3 sprigs of thyme
2 bay leaves
1lb 5oz (600g) small waxy potatoes, thickly sliced
2 tbsp butter
1 tbsp flour
3 cups fish or chicken stock
14oz (400g) salmon fillets, skinned and cut into chunks
⅔ cup half-and-half
2–3 tbsp snipped dill
zest of ½ lemon, finely grated
salt and freshly ground black pepper

1 Heat 1 tbsp of the oil in a wide, deep sauté pan. Add the bacon and cook until crisp. Drain on paper towels and set aside. Pour the remaining oil into the pan, add the scallions, thyme, and bay leaves, and stir-fry for 1 minute. Add the potatoes and cook 2–3 minutes.

2 In another saucepan, melt the butter and beat in the flour. Cook for 1–2 minutes and then gradually add the stock. Bring to a boil and then simmer gently for 3–4 minutes or until thickened slightly. Add the thickened stock to the potatoes and bring to a boil. Cook for 10 minutes without stirring, until the potatoes are just tender.

3 Reduce the heat and submerge the salmon chunks into the stock. Simmer very gently for 3–5 minutes, until the fish is just cooked. Do not stir or the fish will break up.

4 Remove from the heat. Without stirring, pour in the half-and-half and scatter with the dill and lemon zest. Let the soup sit for 5–10 minutes for all the flavors to blend. When ready to serve, gently warm through, discard the thyme and bay leaves, and add seasoning if needed. Ladle into bowls and serve with black pepper and the crispy bacon scattered over the top.